

V. Sister Mary Joseph
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Poor Sisters of Saint Francis too! we might add; and poor religious of every other order! How often they make mistakes! How often they must have cause to regret imprudence! - miscalculation! - disappointment in even most promising candidates! to say nothing of doubtful vocations.

There must have been something about Sr. M.J. as a tiny infant as well as again when she was in her teens, that at least promised appreciation - cooperation with God's grace. So, rather than leave her in some old ash-can or later-on turn her out inexperienced, a probable victim for wolves without conscience or morality, she was nursed-on and mothered as though someone in justice really owed it to her. And now? Bitterness ! ? !

Dear Sister Mary Joseph: what you need most - and you are no exception - is a little more appreciation for what's been done for you. Thank God for it all But don't forget the Fourth Commandment and those who take the place of Father and Mother; - who, in your case have taken that place so long.

Finally, I would ask you to just compare the two short questions; first, the one of Old: "Why should we - Adam and myself - not be permitted to even look at the beautiful Tree?" and then: "Why should we - Sr. M.J. and myself - not have a chance to enjoy 'life' as other girls?"

Just one little question in conclusion. Where do the great majority of the "other girls" come to in their "enjoyment of life"?

If you stop to observe at all you must see that the majority of them find a very short taste of real joy. A sadly portion of them fall to be sickening "flappers", despised by men and women alike; "houses painted in front with vacant attics and nothing stable below".

If you had to deal with the cases of lost virtue and of blighted faculties and of shattered hopes that every confessor and every doctor meets, one of your first prayers would probably something like the following: "From the 'joys of life' as promised by the world and passion; O Lord deliver us!"

Very Sincerely Yours in Christ, Fr. Solanus, O.F.M. Cap.